

A2 Key

Speaking test video: examiner feedback

Part 1

Debora	Inma
Debora gives a mixture of short and long answers. She gives some extended answers, for example when responding to the question, <i>What do you like doing outdoors in your area?</i> However, the details she gives are general examples of what people can do, <i>Well, ... you can go for hiking, trekking and you can visit many places, it's really nice, and if you like you can go to visit the beach, you can go surfing, snorkel ...</i>, rather than a personal response about what she likes doing. Debora's language is mostly accurate, and she uses an appropriate range of vocabulary. Her pronunciation is clear, with minimal examples of weaker control of sounds (i.e. <i>mountain; visit</i>).	Inma gives clear, extended answers to all the questions she is asked, right from the start of the test. She connects her ideas effectively, using linking words, <i>because, but</i>, and referencing, <i>close to mine</i>. Inma's language is generally accurate, although she needs to be careful with continuous tenses, <i>I'm always using simple clothes ... I'm always wearing black things</i>. Her pronunciation is usually clear, although she sometimes drifts off at the end of sentences, which makes some words more difficult to hear.

Tips for Part 1

- Practise talking about yourself, your interests and where you come from.
- Listen carefully to the examiner's question so that you give the correct information.
- Think of ways to develop your answer, such as by giving reasons or examples to support what you say.
- The examiner has to stick to strict timing, so don't worry if he or she has to interrupt you while you are talking.

Part 2

Debora	Inma
Debora gets the conversation started well by speaking directly to her partner, <i>OK, Inma ...</i>, and then asking her a question, <i>What type of food do you like?</i> Later on, she keeps the conversation going by asking another question, <i>Inma, what do you think about the fast food?</i> Asking the examiner to repeat a question – <i>Sorry, can you repeat?</i> – is appropriate, and Debora answers most of his questions effectively. She usually gives extended answers, <i>For me, I prefer a large meal because I don't know when I am going to have time for eat again</i>, but at other times her sentences are short, with limited linking, <i>I don't like too much fruit. I don't like too much vegetables.</i> Although Debora gives a full response to the question <i>Do you prefer eating inside or outside?</i>, she misunderstands what she is being asked and talks about eating out (i.e. at a restaurant), in contrast to eating at home. Debora uses an appropriate range of vocabulary and structures, although there are some problems with word order, <i>I don't like too much fruit.</i> Her pronunciation is clear, and she makes some use of sentence stress to express her opinions effectively.	Inma responds naturally to Debora's questions and uses appropriate strategies to help her organise her thoughts, <i>Well ... , But, ...</i>. She then develops the conversation by asking Debora for her opinion, <i>What do you think about fruit and vegetables?</i> Inma usually checks she has understood the question before giving an answer. She usually answers the examiner's questions effectively, giving more than just simple answers, <i>Yes, of course I think so; Well, I don't have too much time for lunch so I think I prefer to have just a snack.</i> For the question <i>Do you prefer eating inside or outside?</i>, Inma tries to check she has understood, <i>If I prefer to eat at home or ...?</i>, but does not change her response when the examiner repeats the correct question (<i>Inside or outside</i>), so she talks about eating at home compared with eating out. Inma makes good use of linking and referencing to organise her ideas, <i>I don't like too much the desserts, to be honest, because <u>they</u> are just too sweet and I don't like the really really sweet <u>things</u> ... my favourite <u>one</u> could be fruit <u>or also</u> vegetables.</i> She also uses a good range of structures (i.e. language of speculation <i>my favourite one could be fruit</i>) and vocabulary (i.e. <i>a proper meal; speciality</i>) Her pronunciation is clear, but individual sounds and stress for some words lack control, e.g. <i>favourite, vegetables</i> and <i>chocolate</i>.

Tips for Part 2

- Listen carefully to the questions you are asked, so that you give the correct information.
- It's fine to ask the examiner to repeat a question or to check if you have understood the question correctly. This also gives you thinking time.
- Remember that the beginning of this part of the test is a conversation between you and your partner. Practise asking questions and giving your opinion.
- Whenever you are speaking, imagine the examiner or your partner has asked you *Why?* – give them this information without having to be asked.

Overall

Debora	Inma
Grammar and Vocabulary Debora shows control of simple grammatical forms and uses an appropriate range of vocabulary to answer all the questions. Pronunciation Debora's pronunciation is clear, and she demonstrates control of sounds at word and sentence level. Interactive Communication Debora initiates and maintains simple exchanges and does not require any prompting or support. Most of her answers are extended, although she could use more connecting words to join her ideas in longer sentences. Global Achievement Debora handles communication effectively. She is able to produce longer utterances and some more complex language, particularly in the second part of the test.	Grammar and Vocabulary Inma shows a good range of simple and some more complex grammatical forms and she uses a good range of appropriate vocabulary. Pronunciation Inma's pronunciation is generally clear, although this is affected by some mumbling at the end of sentences and some individual sounds at word level. Interactive Communication Inma effectively maintains simple exchanges and requires no prompting. Her responses are extended throughout the test. Global Achievement Inma handles communication effectively, producing long utterances and demonstrating some range of language throughout the test.